



►►►

There was a concern that fixed deposit savers do not get any special treatment. That doesn't seem to have been addressed. What's your view on this?

66 | MN: The country has been encouraging more financial literacy among all citizens. And the more the citizen is literate on the financial front, the more they will take away funds from the current account and put into either mutual funds or fixed deposits, which is natural. The fixed deposit gives comfort to the banks that this money is available for a certain period of time, so that they can use this money for investment somewhere else. Banks will find innovative ways of mobilising resources to lend more to industry.

►►►

What kind of global environment do India's Budget-makers have to contend with?

AS: Global growth and global trade growth are moderating and we don't see that changing over the next two to three years. Increasingly, countries are looking at nearshoring or trying to have as much of the supply chain within their own jurisdictions as possible. It's not decoupling but having more assured supply. We have to work towards making our exports much more competitive.

►►►

Will further depreciation of the rupee help?

AS: The currency of global trade being the dollar, any appreciation does create more competitiveness for our exports, but our imports become more costly. India doesn't look at promoting exports or cutting imports through exchange rate policies. The question is how our economy can become more productive, more competitive. **BT**

@Szarabi



“95-97% TAXPAYERS COULD SHIFT TO NEW REGIME”

Sanjay Kumar Agarwal, Chairman of the CBIC, and Ravi Agarwal, Chairman of the CBDT, on income tax rates, excise duties and more

BY SIDDHARTH ZARABI



PERHAPS, THE BIGGEST takeaway from the Budget was the slew of changes made in terms of tax rates and excise duties. Sanjay Kumar Agarwal, Chairman of the Central Board of Indirect Taxes & Customs, and Ravi Agarwal, Chairman of the Central Board of

Direct Taxes, explain. Edited excerpts:

►►►

Does the Budget announcement on tax cut signal a silent burial of the old tax regime and when will it be formally announced?

Ravi Agarwal: As on date, both the tax